BUSINESS YOUTH LEADERSHIP ASSOCIATION



BYLA OFFICAL RULEBOOK

REAL BUSINESS CHALLENGES. STUDENT-OWNED SOLUTIONS.

THIS RULEBOOK GUIDES STUDENTS, PARENTS AND PARTNERS THROUGH ELIGIBILITY, REGISTRATION, CASE WORK, SUBMISSIONS, LIVE FINALS, JUDGING AND AWARDS.

GRADES 9–12	2–4 STUDENTS PER TEAM	$5 PER PERSON

BEFORE REGISTERING, CHECK THE EVENT NOTICE. ITEMS MARKED "TO CONFIRM" REQUIRE BYLA'S PUBLISHED EVENT-SPECIFIC DETAILS

MODULE ONE

REAL BUSINESS CHALLENGES, OPEN TO EVERY STUDENT

1.1 MISSION AND OBJECTIVES

BYLA CONNECTS GRADES 9–12 STUDENTS TO REAL-WORLD CHALLENGES IN STRATEGY, MARKET RESEARCH, FINANCIAL MODELING, DIGITAL STRATEGY, RISK, ENTREPRENEURSHIP, CONSULTING AND EXECUTIVE PRESENTATION. IT EMPOWERS YOUTH, SUPPORTS LOCAL BUSINESS AND EXPANDS ACCESS TO BUSINESS EDUCATION.

1.2 AN OPEN, STUDENT-DIRECTED MODEL

NO SCHOOL CLUB, DECA CHAPTER OR FACULTY ADVISOR IS REQUIRED. OPEN ENROLLMENT, CROSS-SCHOOL TEAMS, REAL CASES, SPRINTS AND VISUAL DECKS DISTINGUISH BYLA FROM SCHOOL-AFFILIATED PROGRAMS. REGISTRATION: A FLAT $5 PER PERSON. STUDENT TEAMS DEVELOP SOLUTIONS; BUSINESS PARTNERS PROVIDE CHALLENGES AND CONTEXT; MENTORS SUPPORT LEARNING; JUDGES EVALUATE THE WORK.

1.3 FIVE DIRECTORATES

EXECUTIVE SETS DIRECTION AND OVERSEES GOVERNANCE. OPERATIONS MANAGES SCHEDULES, PLATFORMS AND EVENT DELIVERY. CURRICULUM DEVELOPS CASES AND LEARNING RESOURCES. SPONSORSHIPS AND OUTREACH BUILDS PARTNER RELATIONSHIPS. MARKETING AND BRAND MANAGES IDENTITY AND COMMUNICATIONS.

1.4 STRATEGIC OBJECTIVES AND GROWTH BENCHMARKS

TO CONFIRM: BYLA WILL PUBLISH TARGETS, MEASURES AND A REVIEW CYCLE. NO GROWTH BENCHMARKS ARE ESTABLISHED IN THIS RULEBOOK

WHO CAN COMPETE AND HOW TO REGISTER

2.1 STUDENT ELIGIBILITY

ENTRANTS MUST BE IN GRADES 9–12, AGED 13–19 ON THE REGISTRATION CLOSING DATE, AND ATTEND AN ELIGIBLE SCHOOL OR BOARD; CLUB MEMBERSHIP IS NOT REQUIRED. REGIONAL EVENTS MAY PRIORITIZE NEWMARKET, AURORA, EAST GWILLIMBURY AND OTHER YORK REGION COMMUNITIES. VIRTUAL OR NATIONAL EVENTS MAY OPEN ACROSS CANADA; CHECK EACH EVENT'S GEOGRAPHIC ELIGIBILITY.

2.2 TEAM SIZE AND RESPONSIBILITIES

TEAMS HAVE 2–4 STUDENTS; NO SOLO ENTRIES. CROSS-SCHOOL AND CROSS-GRADE TEAMS ARE ENCOURAGED. ASSIGN A TEAM CAPTAIN, LEAD STRATEGIST, FINANCIAL LEAD, AND MEDIA AND PRESENTATION LEAD; SMALLER TEAMS MAY SHARE ROLES. THE CAPTAIN IS THE OFFICIAL CONTACT AND HANDLES REGISTRATION, SUBMISSIONS AND DEADLINES

2.3 REGISTRATION, PAYMENT AND PRIVACY

THE TEAM CAPTAIN PAYS $5 PER PERSON AT REGISTRATION THROUGH THE OFFICIAL SYSTEM. BYLA MUST CONFIRM THE ACCEPTED PAYMENT METHOD AND REFUND TERMS. REGISTRATION COLLECTS NAME, EMAIL, GRADE, SCHOOL, PHONE AND PARENT OR GUARDIAN CONTACT FOR STUDENTS UNDER 18. WE USE THIS DATA ONLY FOR ADMINISTRATION, SAFETY AND COMMUNICATIONS.

2.4 ACCESSIBILITY AND ACCOMMODATION

REQUEST ACCOMMODATIONS BEFORE PARTICIPATION; DESCRIBE THE SUPPORT NEEDED AND ANY SCHEDULING OR PLATFORM BARRIERS, SHARING ONLY NECESSARY PERSONAL INFORMATION. BYLA SHOULD CONFIRM ARRANGEMENTS PRIVATELY AND PUBLISH THE ACCOMMODATION CONTACT AND REQUEST PROCESS

ODULE 3 · COMPETITION FORMAT

ONE LIVE SPRINT, ONE CLEAR TIMELINE.

3.1 THE 3-HOUR LIVE INNOVATION SPRINT

TEAMS PICK ONE OF THREE INDUSTRY TRACKS SPONSORED BY LOCAL BUSINESSES:

A-RETAIL & E COMMERCE,

B-FOOD & HOSPITALITY OR

C-TECH & SERVICES.

THE SPRINT RUNS 12:00–3:00 PM WITH FIVE STAGES; THE STRATEGY SPRINT LASTS 75 MINUTES

TIME	STAGE
12:00 PM	Stage 1: Case release and multi-client briefing
12:15 PM	Stage 2: 75-minute strategy sprint and deck build
1:30 PM	Hard submission deadline (5-slide deck)
1:30 PM	Stage 3: Track semi-finals
2:00 PM	Stage 4: Grand finals pitches
2:45 PM	Stage 5: Awards and networking

3.2 TRACK CHAMPIONS

EACH PARTNER BUSINESS REVIEWS DECKS FOR ITS OWN TRACK AND SELECTS ONE TRACK CHAMPION TO ADVANCE TO THE GRAND FINALS.

3.3 CHECKPOINTS

THE 1:30 PM SUBMISSION LOCK IS THE ONE CHECKPOINT; PORTAL SUBMISSIONS CLOSE SHARP.

3.4 LOGISTICS AND TECHNOLOGY

OPERATIONS OWNS SCHEDULING, TIMEKEEPING AND COMPETITION PLATFORMS. CHECK THE EVENT NOTICE FOR ACCESS LINKS AND TECHNICAL INSTRUCTIONS.

CASE MATERIALS, DATA AND WHO OWNS THE IDEAS.

4.1 READ THE COMPLETE DOSSIER

EACH CASE HAS FOUR PARTS: THE EXECUTIVE SITUATION, THE CORE MANDATE, CONSTRAINTS AND BUDGET, AND A DATA KIT. THE MANDATE DEFINES THE RESULT THE BUSINESS NEEDS— FOR EXAMPLE, REDUCING CHURN BELOW 20% IN SIX MONTHS. THIS IS AN EXAMPLE, NOT A UNIVERSAL TARGET.

4.2 WORK FROM THE SUPPLIED EVIDENCE

THE DATA KIT MAY CONTAIN CSV DATASETS, SURVEYS, MARKETING METRICS, CUSTOMER FEEDBACK AND FINANCIALS. OPERATIONS HANDLES DISTRIBUTION. SEPARATE SUPPLIED FACTS FROM RESEARCH AND ASSUMPTIONS; IDENTIFY GAPS RATHER THAN PRESENTING ESTIMATES AS VERIFIED DATA

4.3 STUDENT OWNERSHIP AND PARTNER LICENSE

THE STUDENT TEAM RETAINS COPYRIGHT OVER ITS ORIGINAL IDEAS, GRAPHICS, FRAMEWORKS AND DECKS. THE PARTNER BUSINESS RECEIVES A PERPETUAL, NON EXCLUSIVE LICENSE TO IMPLEMENT SUBMITTED STRATEGIES.

4.4 CONFIDENTIALITY AND CLIENT DATA SECURITY

TREAT CLIENT DATA AS CONFIDENTIAL. USE APPROVED SHARING CHANNELS, RESTRICT ACCESS TO AUTHORIZED PARTICIPANTS AND AVOID PUBLIC POSTING. FOLLOW CASE SPECIFIC NON-DISCLOSURE INSTRUCTIONS; SEEK APPROVAL BEFORE PLACING CONFIDENTIAL CLIENT MATERIAL IN EXTERNAL TOOLS.

4.5 POST-COMPETITION IMPLEMENTATION

PARTNERS MAY IMPLEMENT SUBMITTED STRATEGIES UNDER THE LICENSE. AGREE DIRECTLY ON ANY FURTHER STUDENT INVOLVEMENT, RESPONSIBILITIES AND DATA ACCESS BEFORE WORK BEGINS

YOUR WORK, YOUR VOICE, AI AS A HELPER

5.1 STUDENT AUTHORSHIP

ALL STRATEGY, MODELS, DECKS AND ANALYSIS MUST BE THE REGISTERED TEAM'S OWN WORK.

5.2 PERMITTED AI SUPPORT

- MARKET DATA SYNTHESIS
- PROOFREADING
- FORMATTING CODE
- EXCEL FORMULA HELP
- BRAINSTORMING
- RESEARCH ORGANIZATION

5.3 PROHIBITED AI OUTPUTS

- CORE STRATEGY
- FINAL PITCH SCRIPT
- EXECUTIVE SUMMARIES
- FABRICATED FINANCIALS
- COMPLETE PRESENTATION
- FINAL RECOMMENDATION

5.4 AI DISCLOSURE APPENDIX

DISCLOSE THE TOOL, PURPOSE, HOW IT WAS USED AND WHAT REMAINED STUDENT-CREATED

5.5 VIOLATIONS AND PENALTIES

TO CONFIRM: BYLA'S REVIEW PROCESS AND SANCTIONS. REVIEW CONCERNS, ALLOW A TEAM RESPONSE AND COMMUNICATE DECISIONS WITH REASONS. NO SPECIFIC PENALTY IS ESTABLISHED HERE.

HOW TEAMS ARE SCORED OUT OF 100

8.1 Five scoring pillars

PILLAR	POINTS
Problem Identification and Analysis	15
Strategic Innovation and Execution	25
Financial Viability	20
Risk Assessment	15
Presentation Delivery and Q&A	25
Total	**100**

8.2 Rubric bands

Problem Identification and Analysis: **13–15** = deep, data-backed root cause; **8–12** = correct but surface-level analysis; **0–7** = misreads the problem. Apply the same three-band logic across all other pillars: strong = evidence-backed and defensible; developing = plausible but incomplete; weak = unsupported or materially flawed. Judges assess strategic originality and execution, coherent financial assumptions, realistic risks and mitigations, and clear delivery with substantive Q&A. To confirm: exact numeric band boundaries for the remaining pillars.

8.3 Judging panel standards

Apply the shared rubric consistently; disclose conflicts; judge submitted work, not school affiliation or personal connections.

8.4 Normalization and deliberation

Review scoring differences against the rubric for fairness across judges. To confirm: BYLA's normalization method and deliberation procedures; no adjustment formula is specified.

MODULE 9 · AWARDS AND NEXT STEPS

PRIZES, FUNDING AND WHAT COMES NEXT

9.1 MONEY GRANTS FOR WINNERS

1ST PLACE MAY WIN A MONEY GRANT FOR UP TO $300
2ND PLACE MAY WIN A MONEY GRANT OF UP TO $200

TO BE SPLIT UP THROUGH TEAMS TO HELP THEM KICKSTART THEIR OWN BUSSINESS

9.2 SPECIAL AWARDS

BEST FINANCIAL MODEL, BEST VISUAL SYSTEM DESIGN, AND MOST INNOVATIVE GTM STRATEGY

9.3 FUNDING DISBURSEMENT

50% AFTER THE COMPETITION; THE REMAINING 50% FOLLOWS MILESTONE DOCUMENTATION, SUCH AS PROOF OF EXECUTION OR TUITION DOCUMENTS.

9.4 TRANSPARENCY AND APPEALS

TEAMS CAN REVIEW SCORES, GET FEEDBACK, REQUEST CLARIFICATION AND FILE FORMAL APPEALS.

9.5 CONTINUED PARTICIPATION

ALUMNI NETWORK, MENTORSHIP, WORKSHOPS, FUTURE COMPETITIONS, INCUBATION AND LEADERSHIP ROLES

MODULE 10

CODE OF CONDUCT, SAFETY & LEGAL TERMS.

10.1 Participant Code of Conduct

BYLA maintains a zero-tolerance approach toward: Harassment; Discrimination; Bullying; Threatening behaviour; Deliberate disruption; Unprofessional conduct. This standard applies to interactions with: Competitors; Mentors; Judges; Staff; Business partners; Volunteers.

10.2 Inclusion

BYLA aims to provide an inclusive environment where students can participate regardless of: School affiliation; Academic background; Business experience; Geographic location.

10.3 Media & Promotional Release

Participation in BYLA events may involve photography, audio recording, video recording, and use of competition submissions for: Promotional purposes; Educational content; Social media; Marketing; BYLA communications. Any required consent or release forms should be provided during registration.

10.4 Liability

BYLA, its directors, officers, partners, and host venues are not responsible for: Loss or damage to personal property; Internet outages; Third-party platform failures; Technical disruptions outside BYLA's reasonable control. Participants are expected to follow all applicable event safety and operational requirements.

10.5 Governing Law & Compliance

BYLA governance, competition policies, and legal agreements are subject to applicable municipal, provincial, and federal laws and regulations.

THE BUSINESS YOUTH LEADERSHIP ASSOCIATION IS COMMITTED TO CREATING A STUDENT-LED BUSINESS ENVIRONMENT BUILT AROUND ACCESSIBILITY, PRACTICAL EXPERIENCE, INNOVATION, PROFESSIONALISM, AND REAL-WORLD PROBLEM SOLVING. THIS RULEBOOK ESTABLISHES THE STANDARD OPERATING FRAMEWORK FOR BYLA COMPETITIONS AND ORGANIZATIONAL ACTIVITIES DURING THE 2026–2027 ACADEMIC YEAR. VERSION: 2.4. ACADEMIC YEAR: 2026–2027. ORGANIZATION: BUSINESS YOUTH LEADERSHIP ASSOCIATION.